

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 12, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:169-176

169 Let my cry come before You, O LORD; Give me understanding according to Your word.

170 Let my supplication come before You; Deliver me according to Your word.

171 My lips shall utter praise, For You teach me Your statutes.

172 My tongue shall speak of Your word, For all Your commandments are righteousness.

173 Let Your hand become my help, For I have chosen Your precepts.

174 I long for Your salvation, O LORD, And Your law is my delight.

175 Let my soul live, and it shall praise You; And let Your judgments help me.

176 I have gone astray like a lost sheep; Seek Your servant, For I do not forget Your commandments.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist asks God to hear his cry and his supplication, and both times he adds the same phrase — "according to Your word": give understanding according to God's word, deliver according to God's word (vv. 169-170).
 - He says his lips will utter praise and his tongue will speak of God's word, because God Himself has taught him His statutes and all God's commandments are righteousness (vv. 171-172).
 - He asks for God's hand to help him, saying he has chosen God's precepts and longs for God's salvation; then he admits he has "gone astray like a lost sheep" and asks God to seek him, because he does not forget God's commandments (vv. 173-176).
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III. Passage Analysis

God's word changes how you think first, then comes out of your mouth

The cry of the psalmist is an expression of prayer, a plea to gain understanding according to Your word. He wanted his thoughts to be transformed according to the word of God. [1]

He doesn't ask for his circumstances to improve first — he asks for his own thinking to be re-set by God's word. Once the thinking shifts, the praise that follows isn't forced; it actually spills out from the inside.

The more you love God's word, the more you see you can wander off

As unconverted sinners are like lost sheep, so weak unsteady saints are like lost sheep. We are apt to wander like sheep, and very unapt, when we have gone astray, to find the way again. [2]

For 175 verses this psalm says how good God's word is — and then in the last verse the psalmist says he has gone astray. Loving God's word doesn't make you need God less; it makes you see more clearly that you need someone to come find you.

IV. Reflection Question

Right now, do you feel close to God, or a little lost? How can you tell?

At the very end of this psalm the writer doesn't say how well he's doing — he says, "Seek Your servant." Being willing to admit you can wander off may be the moment you're closest to God.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik's Commentary on Psalm 119,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on Psalm 119,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Psa/Psa_119.cfm